

From: [Higgins, Michelle \(DEC\)](#)
Sent: Tuesday, March 24, 2026 6:54:54 AM
To: [Katrina Glynn](#)
Cc: [Bayle Reichert](#)
Subject: RE: AWARD: DEC Adirondack and Catskill Park Smart Growth Grant Program Round 8 - Village of Saranac Lake
Sensitivity: Normal

Hi Katrina,

You can do in-kind - \$10,000 is a bit more than reviewers would have liked more admin services but its not terrible. You can change to Salary and add the title, salary, hours worked, % effort funded etc. in the Budget area of the contract, then during the project you would keep timesheets to prove activity and total hours worked. Here's the User Manual - [Grantee / Vendor User Manual](#) about page 155 Reviewing.

Let me know if you need help in SFS or just tell me when you have sent the contract back to me.

Thanks,

Michelle

Michelle Higgins

Environmental Program Specialist 1

Department of Environmental Conservation

Division of Lands and Forests

625 Broadway, 5th Floor, Albany NY 12233

w: 518.402.8460 | michelle.higgins@dec.ny.gov

From: Katrina Glynn <comdev@saranaclakeny.gov>

Sent: Monday, March 23, 2026 5:39 PM

To: Higgins, Michelle (DEC) <Michelle.Higgins@dec.ny.gov>

Cc: Bayle Reichert <comdevassist1@saranaclakeny.gov>

Subject: RE: AWARD: DEC Adirondack and Catskill Park Smart Growth Grant Program Round 8 - Village of Saranac Lake

ATTENTION: This email came from an external source. Do not open attachments or click on links from unknown senders or unexpected emails.

Hi Michelle,

We see that we have a municipal match of \$10k for this grant. Can we satisfy this match with in-kind administrative services? Or some other in-kind services or does it have to be cash?

Thanks,

Katrina

From: Higgins, Michelle (DEC) <Michelle.Higgins@dec.ny.gov>
Sent: Friday, February 13, 2026 12:41 PM
To: Katrina Glynn <comdev@saranacclakeny.gov>
Cc: Trunko, Jillian M (DEC) <Jillian.Trunko@dec.ny.gov>
Subject: AWARD: DEC Adirondack and Catskill Park Smart Growth Grant Program Round 8 - Village of Saranac Lake

Hello Katrina,

Congratulations! This email is to inform you that your organization has been awarded an **Adirondack Park and Catskill Park Community Smart Growth Grant – Round 8 2025**.

**Note: The results of Adirondack and Catskill Community Smart Growth Grant Program will not be publicly announced by DEC for a few more weeks. Please take this email as advance notice of results. We urge awardees to delay any announcements or outreach to media and community in the meantime, as DEC Commissioner Amanda Lefton will be holding a press event in the Adirondack region for these awards. We will send the official press release once it comes to hand.

We want to make sure grantees are well set up and assisted in the beginning of the grant, and throughout this project, and to let you know that we are here to help. Please take the time to go through this email and the attached documents, and we look forward to working with you soon. Suggest make a Grant Folder for Smart Growth so you have everything in one place from the beginning.

Once the forms and insurance detailed below are sent in to michelle.higgins@dec.ny.gov we will be in contact to arrange a Webex call to go over the project and answer questions. You can invite your team members and our admin and program manager will be in attendance as well. We will go over the bid, the Project Summary, Work Plan and Budget areas.

We have 30 days for this section and 90 days total to execute the contract from the date of this email. **The Contract Term is March 1, 2026 – February 28, 2029.**

****By return, please let us know who will be working on this grant (including name, title, email and phone) and who should receive emails for contracting, progress reports and payments. Going forward, please let us know if there are staff changes.**

Next Steps:

1. **Smart Growth Website details** – For general information regarding DEC's ADK and CAT Smart Growth Grant Program, visit <https://dec.ny.gov/lands/49210.html>.
2. **Contacting us at DEC – in the subject line of the email**, please include the name of the organization and where possible the contract number and do this for the life of the contract. We have hundreds of contracts and do not want to make a mistake.
3. **Insurance**– See attached for the insurance requirements for your project:
 1. Municipalities – Workers Comp. and Disability or Exemption (CE-200); no Liability needed.
 2. Non-for-profits, SWCD's and CCE's - if contracting out the project - Workers Comp, Disability or Exemption (CE-200);
 3. Non-for-profits, SWCD's and CCE's - if salaried personnel or volunteers are performing fieldwork, training or hiring volunteers, interns, seasonal workers or employees – Workers Comp, Disability or Exemption (CE-200) plus Liability (ACORD, 30-Day Cancellation, Waiver of Subrogation and Additional Insured – please work with your insurance carrier on this and provide them with the attached insurance requirements – 90% of awardees get this

wrong if they don't send the attached requirements.

Please send in one email to michelle.higgins@dec.ny.gov.

4. **MWBE and SDVOB** - See attached in this email Policy Statement to sign and Equal Opportunity Staffing Plan to be completed for staff and known contractors already on board for this project.

MWBE Utilization Plan - An MWBE Utilization Plan is required to be submitted prior to contract execution. To submit an MWBE Utilization Plan, log in to [NYS CS](https://nyscs.ny.gov). For further guidance, refer to the attached Utilization Plan manual. Contact MWBE@dec.ny.gov if the plan is not visible on the dashboard.

Please remember: There is a 30% goal on all ADK and CAT Community Smart Growth Grant Program grant contract awards unless otherwise determined. It is crucial to emphasize that adherence to NYS Executive Law Article 15-A mandates MWBE compliance through the demonstration of thorough Good Faith Efforts (GFE). Simply advertising in the NYS Contractor Reporter will not suffice. Grantees and contractors must actively engage and solicit MWBEs and SDVOBs for subcontracting opportunities within the grant contract budget to ensure compliance. Please feel free to use the Good Faith Efforts Guide and MWBE Solicitation Log to track GFE.

For assistance in ensuring compliance with GFE or creating an MWBE vendor list for solicitation, please contact MWBE@dec.ny.gov. This is highly recommended.

Service-Disabled Veteran-Owned Businesses (SDVOB) - NYSDEC - Contractors with a SDVOB subcontracting goal established within their contract must make good-faith efforts to subcontract SDVOBs for the percentage of the contract outlined in the SDVOB section of the contract. Contractors must complete and upload the [SDVOB-100 Utilization Plan](#) in SFS prior to the contract execution, even if a contractor has not been chosen yet.

[SDVOB-101 Quarterly Compliance forms](#) will be submitted to sdvob@dec.ny.gov on the 10th of the month following each quarter.

Please remember: There is a 6% goal on all ADK and CAT Smart Growth Grant Program grant contract awards unless otherwise determined. It is crucial to emphasize that adherence to NYS Veteran Services' Law, Article 3 mandates SDVOB compliance through the demonstration of thorough Good Faith Efforts (GFE). Simply advertising in the NYS Contractor Reporter will not suffice. Grantees and contractors must actively engage and solicit MWBEs and SDVOBs for subcontracting opportunities within the grant contract budget to ensure compliance. Please reach out to SDVOB@DEC.NY.GOV with any questions.

Good Faith Effort Guide – See attached, the Good Faith Effort is used after bidding is completed or if a waiver will be requested. Use the Solicitation log or an MWBE Directory list to show details of MWBE vendors and contractors solicited for your project and the results. This should be sent to mwbe@dec.ny.gov for review.

5.Pre-Contract work – Please take time to read the Guidelines for All Awardees. At this time, most awardees will meet with their staff and other partners and map out the project responsibilities, including Outreach & Education where applicable. Any work that does not incur costs against the funding can be done, including compiling bidding documents or quotes.

6.Bidding – MWBE and SDVOB for this grant round will include bidding for contractors. While the DEC will work with grantees as per their local procurement policy, we expect that everyone will either issue formal bids or request three estimates depending on the project.

7.SFS Grants Management - The contract for this award will be completed and signed in Grants Management and the Progress Reports will also be submitted to Grants Management and we will host a webinar in June 2026 for grantees to go through the progress report portal in SFS GM. Roles and id's/passwords in SFS/Grants Management should be accessed and available for the people that will work on this contract. Claim Form packages for project reimbursement will be sent to me, although we will be moving to SFS GM for voucher/ Claim Form payments at some point during 2026. The current Claim Form is attached in this email.

8. Roles for Grantees in SFS GM - Everyone has a Primary Contact in SFS GM and that person can give out roles to others in order for them to submit Progress Reports. See the basics of how to set roles for people in your organization at this link [SFS Handbook: Grantee Processing in SFS](#) – page 13 of the document [Maintaining Grantee Information](#). We suggest you check into your primary contact information without delay and definitely within the next 30

days – **let me know if you need help**. Everyone should have all the roles except Contract Approver and reserve that for the appropriate person/s. Once you have roles you will be able to access all areas of SFS and work on the contract. Work on the contract cannot begin until it is routed to you after insurance, MWBE forms are received and the contract call is completed. You will need people to have roles for Claim Forms later in 2026, submitting progress reports and contract approval as well as grant initiation and submission.

9.Contract – Work can begin at your own risk as of the Contract Start Date, which is anticipated to be **2/1/2026** for everyone. Payments can be begin and costs can be incurred once the Master Contract for Grants (MCG) is executed, anticipated by **4/1/2026**. After the contract Work Plan is approved by DEC and grantee (you), it will be sent on for agency signatures. The Awardee's Contract Approver in SFS Grants Management will receive an email when the grantee needs to go on and 'sign' electronically. This should be the top elected official or department head, and the CEO equivalent in non-for-profits. We have 90 days total to 'build' the contract and fulfill this contract requirement, starting with today's date.

10.Payments/Claim Forms – see attached. Please send reimbursement Payment Request Packages to michelle.higgins@dec.ny.gov. DEC does not yet have the ability to submit Claim Forms through SFS/Grants Management but we will during 2026. Once a Claim Form is approved, it is processed in our office within a few days and then the State will send reimbursement electronically within 30 days. See page 1 of the Claim Form Package attached for directions for signing up with E-Pay.

11.EPF attribution – attached is the EPF attribution for the EPF funding of this grant along with a DEC logo. The funding attribution should be used in all education and outreach and wherever the grant is discussed such as press releases and social media but would also include kiosk artwork, Comp Plans, signage of all sorts etc.

12.DEC ADK and CAT Community Smart Growth Press Release - please utilize the attached press release to announce your grant award locally and on your websites/social media. Where possible, forward any press to us!

13. Non-for-profits – please check your pre-qualification status and make sure current forms are available. The forms most commonly missed are the ones for Charities Registration and tax forms.

Thank you for your prompt attention to developing this contract and congratulations again. Let us know if you have questions – there is a lot to take in at once!

Kind regards,

Michelle

Michelle Higgins

Environmental Program Specialist 1

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